Instructions

1. The tiles are split into two rooms: tiles 1-4 are Room A and tiles 5-10 are Room B.
2. Shuffle the cards and place one card face down on each tile.
3. Each card is one of three things: empty, an item (for example the fuse), or the generator.
4. The Guard starts on tile 1. The Ghost starts on tile 10.
5. Put the hourglass next to the board.

Goal

- Guard: find the fuse, bring it to the generator and install it to restore the power.
- Ghost: catch the Guard first.

How to play

Players take turns. The Guard goes first.

Guard's turn

1. Move up to 3 tiles left or right.
2. Flip the card on the tile you stand on, if it is still face down. You can look at it. If it is an item, you may take it.
3. If you stand on the generator and hold the fuse, install it. The power is back and you win.

Ghost's turn

1. Move up to 2 tiles left or right.
2. If the Ghost reaches the Guard's tile, the Guard is caught and the Ghost wins.

The Ghost does not flip cards and cannot take items.

The flashlight

- To turn it on, the Guard says "ON" and starts the hourglass.
- To turn it off, the Guard says "OFF" and stops the hourglass.

- Range: 1 tile. The light only reaches the tile right next to the Guard, in the direction he is facing. A Ghost further away is not lit and can move.
- A Ghost inside the light (the tile right next to the Guard) cannot move. The moment the light is off, or the Ghost is no longer in the light, it can move again.
- The hourglass is the battery. When the sand runs out, the flashlight is dead for the rest of the game.
- The battery does not recharge, so use it carefully.

Round 2

After the first game, swap roles. The Guard becomes the Ghost and the Ghost becomes the Guard. The facilitator moves the cards to different tiles and you play again.

Question 1: How did you translate digital mechanics into paper form?

The digital game is a 2D side-on game, so I kept that view in the paper prototype. The board is one row of 10 tiles, like a side view of the museum. The first 4 tiles are one room, and the other 6 tiles are a second room. Each tile has one face-down card. When the guard reaches a tile, the player flips the card to see what is there. A card can be empty, can show an item such as the fuse, or can show the thing that must be fixed for the puzzle, such as the generator.

Two people played each test: one was the guard and one was the ghost. The guard could move up to 3 tiles per turn and the ghost up to 2 tiles. To use the flashlight, the guard said “on” and we started an hourglass, which acted as the battery. To stop, the guard said “off” and the hourglass stopped. While the light was on the ghost, the ghost could not move. After the first game, the players swapped roles and played again. For the second game I moved the cards to different tiles, so the players could not rely on what they had seen before.

The core mechanics are the same as in digital design, but some differences could affect the results. In the digital game the guard and the ghost move freely, in real time. On paper, movement is limited and turn based. This removes the time pressure, so the paper version is probably calmer and easier than the real game. The hourglass also depends on the players saying “on” and “off” honestly, so it is less exact than a real battery. The ghost was a human, not an AI, so it could think and adapt, and it may be smarter or less consistent than the digital ghost. Finally, the face-down cards hide information. In the digital game the

player can see the rooms, but on paper they had to remember what was under each tile.

Question 2: After the playtest, what changes should you make, and what did you observe?

The playtest suggests that the mechanics can work together. Both players understood the flashlight and used it, and both found the fuse and got the generator working. So they could manage the flashlight, the escape and the puzzle at the same time. The battery also created real choices. Player 1 used more than half of the battery and was caught twice. Player 2 only used the light when the ghost was close and was never caught. This suggests that the limited battery makes players decide when to use the light, which is what I wanted.

The main problem was memory. Both players found the fuse, but then forgot where the generator was. Because the cards were face down and the layout changed in the second game, they had to remember everything by themselves. Part of this comes from the paper format, but the digital game could have the same problem if the rooms are not easy to tell apart. So, my top priority is to make the generator room more memorable. On paper I could use a different color or a clear picture, or leave a card face up once it has been flipped. In the digital game I could add a light or a humming sound to the generator room.

There are also smaller points. Battery use was very different between the two players, so I would watch it in more tests before changing the numbers. Two players is a small sample, and the paper version has no real-time pressure. Next time I would test with more people and add a time limit to test multitasking better.